

THE GREAT MAP ROOM

Create a Map with Essential Elements

*What does a mapmaker need to include so that
any reader can understand the map?*

The Director's Challenge

You've spent weeks repairing maps in the Great Map Room -- fixing missing elements, correcting directions, sorting map types, measuring distances, comparing globes, and reading charts.

Today, the museum director says:

"I know you can read a map.

But can you make one?"

Museum director standing

Responsibility

A responsible person does what they're supposed to do -- even the parts that seem small. When a mapmaker skips the scale or forgets the legend, the map becomes harder to read.

Today, take responsibility for every part of your map so visitors can trust it.

From Map Reader to Mapmaker

NOTICE

Reading a Map

You follow what someone else drew.

You use the title, legend, and compass rose that are already there.

INSERT IMAGE

Making a Map

You decide what to include.

You think about what the reader will need -- and add it yourself.

INSERT IMAGE

The Reader Test

NAME

A good mapmaker asks:

"If someone picked up this map and knew nothing about this place, could they understand it?"

If the answer is no, something is missing.

CHAT FRAME

"What would happen if your map had no title?"

"What if you used symbols but didn't explain them?"

"How would a visitor know which way is north?"

The Mapmaker's Checklist

Part 1: Title and Compass Rose

TITLE

The first thing a reader sees. It tells them what place or topic the map shows. Without it, they're guessing.

INSERT IMAGE

Close-up of a map title reading 'Map of Florida State Parks'

COMPASS ROSE

Shows all eight directions (N, S, E, W, NE, SE, SW, NW). Really important.

INSERT IMAGE

Decorative compass rose showing all eight directions

The Mapmaker's Checklist

Part 2: Scale and Legend

SCALE

Tells readers how far apart things really are. Without a scale, two places might look close but be hundreds of miles apart.

INSERT IMAGE

Map scale bar showing '1 inch = 50 miles'

LEGEND + SYMBOLS

Every symbol on the map must appear in the legend with i
the legend says so.

INSERT IMAGE

Map legend showing symbols: blue line = river

Why Does Every Element Matter?

NARRATE

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *What does this map show, and what choice or pattern does it help us explain?*
- *If you removed the compass rose, what questions could a reader no longer answer?*
- *Why is building a map harder than reading one?*
- *How does responsibility connect to being a good mapmaker?*

MAPMAKER SECRET

Draw your compass rose and
won't run out of room for the

Smart mapmakers plan ahead

Watch Me Plan a Map

Teacher models thinking step by step

"If I were making a map of our school..."

- 1. Title:** "Map of Sunshine Elementary"
- 2. Compass Rose:** Draw it first so I don't run out of room
- 3. Symbols + Legend:** Blue square = library, green circle = playground, red triangle = office
- 4. Scale:** 1 inch = 50 feet
- 5. Check:** Does my map pass the Reader Test?

Teacher-drawn ex

Match the Element to Its Job

Work together -- can you match each element to what it does?

Title

Tells you what place or topic the map shows

Compass Rose

Shows all eight directions

Scale

Tells you how far apart things really are

Plan Your Map Elements

Think of a real place you know. In your Curator's Notebook, answer:

1

What would your map's TITLE be?

2

Name at least TWO symbols you'd use and what they mean.

3

Where would you put the compass rose?

4

What would your scale say? (Example: 1 inch = 100 feet)

What's Wrong with This Map?

A student made this map. Can you spot what's missing or wrong?

INSERT IMAGE

A student-drawn map with NO TITLE, a compass rose with only N/S/E/W (missing intermediate directions), symbols on the map but NO LEGEND, and no scale

ERRORS TO FIND

- 1. No title
- -- Reader doesn't know what the symbols mean
- 2. Missing intermediate directions
- 3. No legend-- Symbols are not defined
- 4. No scale-- Can't tell real distance

Responsible Mapmakers Build Trust

EXHIBIT LABEL

A responsible mapmaker includes a title, compass rose, scale, and legend with symbols so that any reader -- even someone who's never seen the place -- map is harder than reading one, because the mapmaker has to think about what the reader needs.

PAUSE AND THINK

Check Your Understanding

Q1

Why is building a map harder than reading one?

- A Because maps are always confusing
- B Because you need expensive tools
- C Because the mapmaker has to think about what the reader will need

Q2

You draw a blue triangle for a lake. Where should you explain what it means?

- A In the legend

One More Check

Q3

A responsible mapmaker should always check that their map has...

- A Bright colors and fancy borders
- B A title, compass rose, scale, and legend
- C At least ten symbols

KEY TAKEAWAY

Maps don't need to be fancy -- they need to be CLEAR. The four essential elements are title, compass rose, scale, and legend. A responsible mapmaker ch

What You'll Turn In

Evidence Questions -- answer using details from the lesson

1

Why is building a map harder than just reading one? Use an example from the lesson to explain.

Hint: Think about what the mapmaker has to decide that the reader doesn't.

2

How does being responsible connect to being a good mapmaker?

Hint: Connect the virtue of responsibility to what you learned about including map elements.

Curator Task: My Map Plan

Describe a map you would create for the museum.

The museum director wants to see your map plan. Pick a real place you know -- your neighborhood, school, a park, or a town. Describe the map you would make. In 3 sentences, write the title, symbols, and legend. What symbols would you use, and what would the legend say? How would the compass rose, scale, and legend help a visitor read your map?

Write 3-4 sentences with the title, at least two symbols, and how the essential elements help readers.

Turn-In Checklist

☐

I answered both evidence questions.

☐

I completed the Curator Task (my map plan).

☐

I wrote my Curator's Chronicle.

☐

I copied or downloaded my work and submitted to Canvas.

Great Work, Mapmaker!

You proved you can think like a mapmaker --
planning every element so a visitor can understand your map.
The director is impressed!

COMING NEXT

The Map Skills Challenge